

Alcaraz wins in three sets as Kartal marks her WTA return

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Carlos Alcaraz and Sonay Kartal recorded victories as they returned to tour tennis after injury breaks. Their matches took place at different tournaments, with Alcaraz competing in Japan and Kartal in China.

Defending Japan Open champion Alcaraz defeated Alex Michelsen 7-6 (7-1) 4-6 6-1. He needed a **tie-break** to win the first set, lost the second, then won the deciding set. In tennis, a **tie-break** is a shorter scoring contest used when a set is level in games.

The Spanish world number three had been **sidelined** for just over five months by a wrist injury. He returned at the US Open, reaching the quarter-finals before this appearance on the ATP Tour. The ATP Tour is the main men's professional tennis **circuit**.

His serve was **inconsistent** against Michelsen. He produced five **aces**, which the receiver could not touch, but also five double faults. A double fault happens when a player misses both service attempts and loses the point.

At the China Open in Beijing, Britain's Kartal beat Spain's Andrea Lazaro Garcia 6-2 6-3. The 24-year-old injured her lower back at Indian Wells in March and had been away from the WTA Tour for almost six months. The WTA Tour is the main women's professional tennis **circuit**.

Kartal first returned to competition at the Billie Jean King Cup on September 22, narrowly losing to Marie Bouzkova. She then won in Beijing. Ranked 129th in the world, she will next face Chinese 31st seed Wang Xinyu as she tries to move back up the rankings.

Word Treasure

defending -- Trying to win again after winning the previous tournament.

tie-break -- A shorter scoring contest used to decide a set tied in games.

sidelined -- Unable to take part for a period of time.

circuit -- A series of competitions in a sport.

aces -- Successful serves that the receiver cannot touch.

inconsistent -- Changing in quality instead of staying steady.

Background you need

The ATP Tour is the main men's professional tennis circuit; the WTA Tour is the main women's professional tennis circuit.

An ace is a successful serve the receiver cannot touch. A double fault loses the server the point.

Break it down

Introduces victories at two different tournaments.

Describes Alcaraz's three-set win and explains a tie-break.

Reviews Alcaraz's injury break, US Open return and serving.

Describes Kartal's China Open win and injury break.

Ends with Kartal's earlier return, ranking and next opponent.

Why it matters

The results show both players competing successfully on tour after injury breaks. Kartal's next match continues her attempt to climb the rankings.

Test what you remember

1. How did Alcaraz win the first set against Michelsen?
 - (A) By winning every game
 - (B) By winning a tie-break
 - (C) By receiving a walkover
 - (D) By taking the deciding set
2. How far did Alcaraz reach at the US Open on his return?
 - (A) The semi-finals
 - (B) The opening round
 - (C) The tournament final
 - (D) The quarter-finals
3. What were Alcaraz's serving totals against Michelsen?
 - (A) Five aces and five double faults
 - (B) Three aces and five double faults
 - (C) Three aces and three double faults
 - (D) Five aces and three double faults
4. Where did Kartal injure her lower back in March?
 - (A) At the China Open
 - (B) At Indian Wells
 - (C) At the Japan Open
 - (D) At the US Open
5. Who narrowly beat Kartal at the Billie Jean King Cup?
 - (A) Wang Xinyu
 - (B) Andrea Lazaro Garcia
 - (C) Marie Bouzkova
 - (D) Alex Michelsen
6. What does the article say the WTA Tour is?
 - (A) A single tennis tournament held in Japan
 - (B) A team competition between tennis nations
 - (C) The main women's professional tennis circuit
 - (D) The main men's professional tennis circuit

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: A 4: B 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):